



Lake Victoria

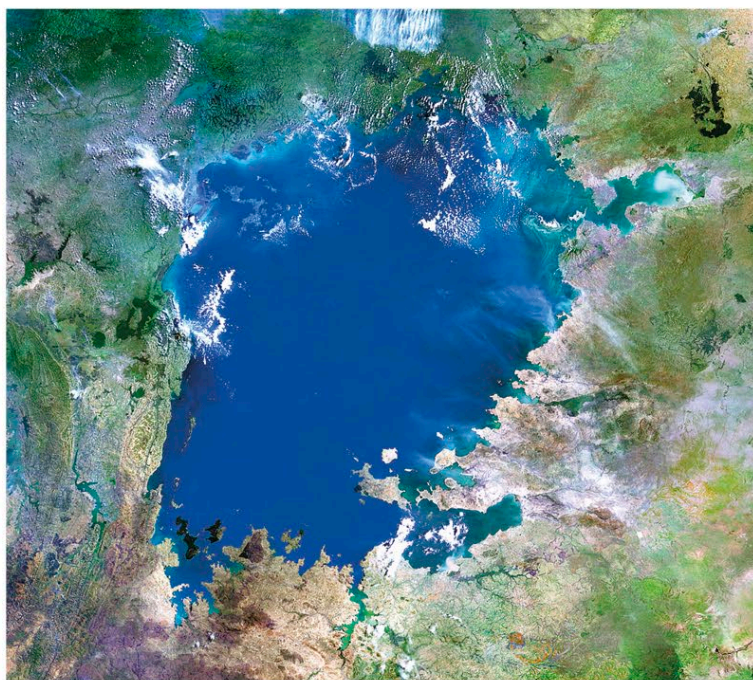
Africa's largest lake and the second largest in the world, the major source of the Nile

Lake Victoria sits in a shallow depression on a plateau between two arms of the Great Rift Valley (see pp.184–87) in East Africa and is bordered by Uganda, Kenya, and Tanzania. It is the largest of the African Great Lakes and, with an area of more than 26,500 square miles (68,800 square km), it is the second largest freshwater lake in the world by area after Lake Superior (see pp.50–51). However, it is shallow for its size, with an average depth of only 130 ft (40 m).

Lake Victoria is the source of the White Nile (see pp.190–91), its only outlet, which is known as the Victoria Nile at its start. The Kagera is the largest river entering the lake, from the west, but the lake receives most of its water from rainfall.

▷ LONG TOES

The African jacana is a tropical wading bird with long toes and claws that enable it to walk across floating vegetation, such as lily pads, in shallow lakes.



△ INTRICATE SHORELINE

The lengthy shores of Lake Victoria, seen here from space, provide access to freshwater for millions of people, including those in several large cities such as Uganda's capital, Kampala.

▽ AQUATIC ANTELOPE

An antelope found in the wetlands of southern Africa, the red lechwe has long, widely splayed hooves that help it run on soft ground and a water-repellent coat that aids swift movement through water.

